

Exadel upgrades its facial recognition service

Exadel, a Silicon Valley based software consultancy and engineering firm, has updated its CompreFace open source facial recognition service with a slew of new features aimed at improving the customer experience and broadening its integration with other systems.

CompreFace, a face biometrics app that uses deep neural networks, released an initial version in November 2020 for a variety of industries including retail, hospitality, and travel. Exadel has now released version 1.0 to improve the user experience with a new user interface (UI), no-code options, ease of deployment, and new integrations.

The updated user interface manages subjects and images to begin facial collection without the use of scripts or code. Exadel claims that it also aids in the resolution of facial recognition issues by allowing users to check for correct images saved in each subject.



With the open source library Double Take, CompreFace developers can now write integrations that allow CCTV facial recognition without writing any custom code. Frigate, a network video recorder with real-time local object detection, is also linked to CompreFace for facial recognition. The file server system unRAID can also be integrated using the CompreFace and Double Take templates.

Serhii Pospelov, head of the AI practice at Exadel, said, “With the support of the developer community, Exadel has continued to improve the CompreFace user experience. As AI practices continue to rise, we are seeing more use cases emerge for facial recognition. This open source service allows anyone to enter the facial recognition market and access highly reliable services without needing deep coding or machine learning experience.”

Atom text editor will officially be terminated later this year

On December 15 this year, Microsoft’s GitHub will shut down Atom, its open source text editor that inspired and influenced widely used commercial apps such as Microsoft Visual Studio Code, Slack, and GitHub Desktop. The social code company stated that it is doing so to focus on cloud based software.

When Microsoft acquired GitHub in June 2018, Nat Friedman, the CEO at the time, reassured the GitHub community that Atom was still alive and well.

Atom has come to a halt after four years of progress. Apart from maintenance and security updates, the project hasn’t seen significant feature development in several years, according to GitHub. Community involvement has declined during this time, and the business of locally installed software now appears less appealing than the potential recurring revenue, vendor lock-in, and information gathering enabled by cloud based apps.

Crane Venture Partners offers funding to early-stage founders

London based Crane Venture Partners (CVP) is a venture capitalist firm focused on open source based businesses.

The company claims that its first 2019 US\$ 90-million fund led the industry in seed to Series A graduation rates. In other words, it excelled at assisting new businesses in getting off the ground. CVP has now raised US\$ 140 million in its second fund to support early-stage founders.

This new fund focuses on artificial intelligence, data, and developer tools in addition to open source. The firm collaborates with early-stage founders to create the platforms and tools that will power tomorrow’s software infrastructure. Crane does not simply sign a blank check and wait to see if you sink or swim. Its partners serve as extensions of the founders’ teams. They are especially useful in areas where many technology companies lack expertise, such as marketing, sales, and customer success.



Crane’s first fund invested 60 per cent of its assets in the United Kingdom, 20 per cent in Germany, and 10 per cent in Swiss companies. Its second fund is expected to invest 50 per cent of its assets in the United Kingdom, with the remainder spread across Europe, Israel, and the United States. Crane’s second fund has already funded nearly 20 companies. Encord, Encore, Novu, Nuclia, Qovery, Restack, SeeChange, and Veratrak are examples.